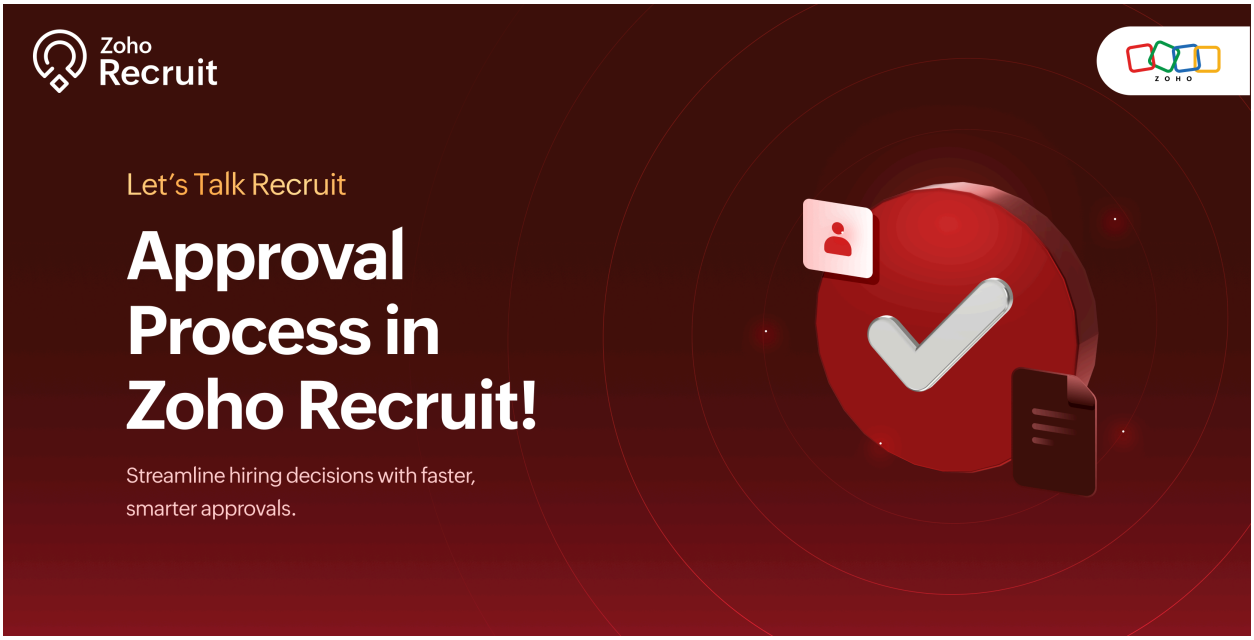
Let's Talk Recruit: An approval process with zero follow-ups

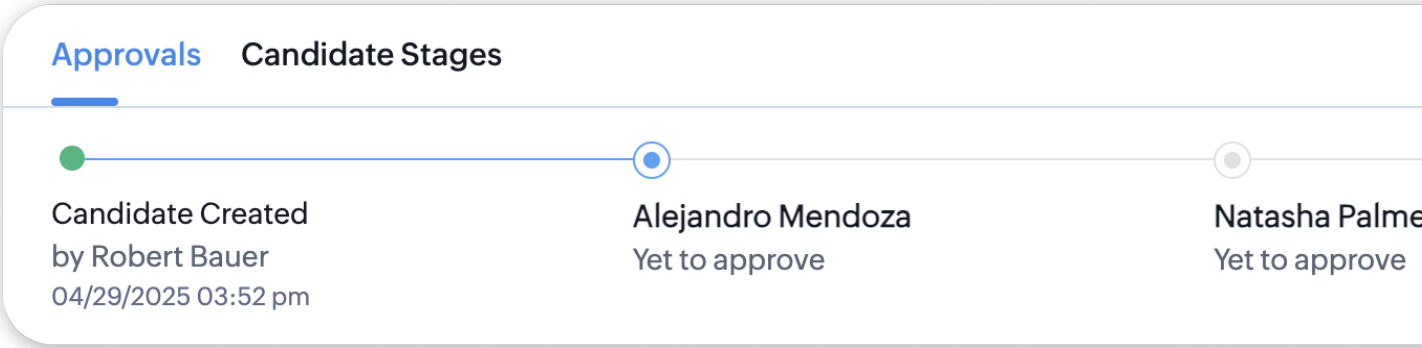


Welcome back to our **"Let's Talk Recruit"** series! Today, the topic of discussion is the Approval process. We'll look into how approval workflows function in recruitment, explore real-world use cases, and show how automation in Zoho Recruit can streamline approvals and drive efficiency in your organization.

What is an Approval Process?

An **Approval Process** is a structured workflow used to authorise various stages in the recruitment process, such as **job requisitions, candidate approvals, and offer letters.** Automating approvals in Zoho Recruit ensures efficiency, reduces delays, and eliminates miscommunication.

For instance, when a recruiter shortlists a candidate for a specific role, the hiring manager must approve the selection before scheduling further rounds. Additionally, once a final candidate is chosen, approval from HR and upper management is required before extending an offer.



Why Automate Approvals?

It automates the repetitive, cumbersome, and time-consuming tasks

Without Automation	With Automated Approvals
Manual follow-ups	Automatic notifications
Delayed decisions	Timely approvals
Miscommunication	Clear approval trails
Lost candidates	Faster hiring cycles
Inconsistent process	Standardized workflows

How does Approval Process function?

The diagram above illustrates how a typical approval workflow functions in Zoho Recruit:

When should you use an Approval Process?

Objective:

A recruitment agency needs a streamlined process to manage approvals for job offers sent to selected candidates before finalizing the hiring process.

Example Scenario:

A recruitment firm works with multiple client companies to hire candidates. When a candidate is selected after the final interview, the job offer must be approved internally before it is sent out. The HR manager and finance team must review the

offer details, such as salary, benefits, and contract terms, before the final approval. They want the approval process to be automated so that:

1. **Automated Approval Initiation:**
   Once a recruiter selects a candidate and generates a job offer, the approval process should start automatically to avoid delays.
2. **Multi-Level Approvals:**
   - ☆ The job offer must first be approved by the **HR manager** to ensure compliance with company policies.
   - ☆ If the salary exceeds a predefined limit, it must be reviewed by the **finance department** to verify budget availability.
3. **Pending Background Verification:**
   If a candidate's background verification is still pending, the offer should not be sent until the verification is completed and approved.
4. **Final Offer Dispatch:**
   Once the approvals are received, the system should automatically send the final job offer via email to the candidate with a confirmation notification.

Candidate Added

A candidate is selected for a job opening.

Initial Offer Shared

An initial offer is made to the candidate.

Candidate Counter

The candidate propo
a higher counteroff

Hiring Manager Approval

Since the counteroffer exceeds the initial offer, it is sent to the hiring manager for approval.

Finance Head Approval

If the hiring manager approves bu
the counteroffer is above budget, th
request is escalated to the finance
head for further approval.

Finance Decision

The finance head reviews and either approves the offer or revises the offer amount.

Recruiter Informs Candidat

The recruiter receives the final decisi
and communicates the updated offe
the candidate.

Zoho
Recruit

Here's a challenge for you:

Identify activities that need automatic approvals. Create a rule and set up a trigger. Send approval requests automatically and put it to test

Start small—maybe automate email approvals or candidate shortlisting—and build from there!

Let’s Talk Recruit!

Now Over to You!

Have you used approval processes in your hiring workflow? What’s your favorite feature in Zoho Recruit’s approval system? Drop a comment and let’s share ideas!

Let’s help each other recruit smarter.